



AS WELL AS BEING THE LARGEST COUNTRY IN South America

BRAZILIANS

LIFE IN THE LAND OF CARNIVAL

by far (it's even bigger than the continental United States), Brazil has one of the world's longest coastlines. Founded in the 16th

City mix

Nearly 80 percent of Brazilians live in cities—the largest are São Paulo and Rio de Janeiro. Most people are Hispanic, but a significant number belong to immigrant communities from Europe, Africa, and the Middle and Far East; there are more Japanese in São Paulo than in any city outside Japan. Each city contains both wealthy, Westernized districts, and areas that are very poor.



STREET LIFE

Clinging to the steep hills behind it, Rio de Janeiro's shantytowns or *favelas* are a triumph of human spirit over deprivation. Assembled from found materials like plastic, sheet metal, and odd bricks, these precarious structures support a complex and lively street culture.

AIMING FOR A GOAL

Soccer was introduced to Brazil by Scottish engineers at the end of the 19th century. Since then, the game has become not just a symbol of patriotic pride, but almost a national obsession, and Brazilian players are among the best in the world. The small boys kicking a ball around this São Paulo *favela* know that becoming a sports hero is one way to escape their bleak surroundings.



CARNIVAL

The exuberant street festival known as Carnival is the most important event in the Brazilian calendar. Once a year, in the days leading up to Ash Wednesday, thousands of costumed revelers pour through the cities, singing, dancing, and playing musical instruments. The most famous of all Brazilian Carnivals is in Rio de Janeiro; here, a fantastic fruity float makes its way down one of the wide thoroughfares.

